

● EASY

● CRAFT AND STRUCTURE

● ANSWER KEY

Text Structure and Purpose

01

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**B**

B. It describes a limitation of some studies about the origin of turtles.

Choice B is the best answer. The sentence mentions that some fossil studies have relied on incomplete data sets, suggesting that these studies are limited in what they can tell us about turtles' origins.

Choice A is incorrect. While the sentence mentions the incompleteness of the data sets studied, it doesn't mention any tools or techniques used to examine fossils. Choice C is incorrect. The sentence doesn't mention anything about the evolution of crocodiles. Choice D is incorrect. This sentence doesn't directly mention or criticize any "widely held belief," and it focuses on a limitation of fossil studies of reptiles, not genetic studies.

Q2**D**

D. It provides context that clarifies the significance of the information that follows in the rest of the sentence.

Choice D is the best answer. The text describes how a new discovery expands our understanding of Denisovans. The underlined portion describes what we used to believe about Denisovans, which helps the reader understand the significance of the discovery of the molar: it suggests that they lived in more places than we'd previously thought.

Choice A is incorrect. The underlined portion doesn't do this. Instead, it explains what we used to believe about Denisovans before the discovery—it doesn't dismiss the new discovery as false. Choice B is incorrect. The underlined portion doesn't do this. No term is defined here. Choice C is incorrect. The underlined portion doesn't do this. The text never tells us what the "goal" of the research was, just what its discovery was.

Q3

C

- C. To give an example of how Ormes presented the experiences of Black Americans in her comic strips
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Choice C is the best answer. The text describes how *Torchy Brown* depicted the experiences of a young Black woman experiencing America's Great Migration. It further states that Ormes continued to use comics throughout her career to humorously comment on important issues impacting Black Americans.

Choice A is incorrect. The text never mentions other Black women comic strip writers. Choice B is incorrect. The text never mentions any changes in the subjects Ormes addressed. Choice D is incorrect. The text never mentions the inspiration for characters in *Torchy Brown*.

Q4

D

- D. It presents a study that addresses an unresolved question about the presence of forests along streams in agricultural environments.
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Choice D is the best answer. The author first describes an unresolved question: what effect do bank forests have on stream biodiversity? Then the author presents a study that answers the question: bank forests increase stream biodiversity.

Choice A is incorrect. This isn't the main purpose of the text. The text never mentions agricultural yields. Choice B is incorrect. This isn't the main purpose of the text. The text never mentions other kinds of agricultural environments. Choice C is incorrect. This isn't the main purpose of the text. The text never mentions any previously held view about how fish in these streams try to avoid predators.

Q5

C

C. It provides an answer to the question in the previous sentence.

Choice C is the best answer because it best describes how the underlined sentence functions in the text as a whole. The text begins with a question: have penguins always been unable to fly? The underlined sentence then presents an answer that has been offered by researchers, indicating that Theresa Cole and her team believe that penguins were once able to fly but lost that ability long ago as they began living in the sea. The text then describes the research that led to that answer. Thus, the function of the underlined sentence is to provide an answer to the question in the previous sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because none of the terms used in the sentence that follows are defined in the underlined sentence; no definitions are given at all. Instead, the sentence presents Theresa Cole and her team's answer to the earlier question about penguins' ability to fly. Choice B is incorrect because there is no contradiction between the underlined sentence and the sentence that follows since both convey that at some point penguins underwent adaptations that limited their ability to fly and helped them swim and live in the sea. Instead of contradicting later information, the underlined sentence presents an answer to the earlier question about penguins' ability to fly. Choice D is incorrect because the question in the previous sentence is about penguins' ability to fly and the underlined sentence presents Theresa Cole and her team's answer to that question based on their research into penguin flight, which is described in the rest of the text.

Q6

C

C. It identifies some reasons why the map is impressive.

Choice C is the best answer because it best describes how the underlined sentence functions in the text as a whole. The text presents information about a map drawn by Blackfoot chief Ac Ko Mok Ki in 1801. The underlined sentence states that the map "demonstrates a vast amount of topographic knowledge" and mentions that it features the "specific names of mountains and rivers" and includes the first-known sketch of the Missouri River's drainage network. These are all characteristics that indicate that the map was executed with remarkable skill. Thus, the underlined sentence identifies some reasons why the map is impressive.

Choice A is incorrect. Though the sentence after the underlined sentence in the text mentions that Ac Ko Mok Ki included information about other tribes on his map, the underlined sentence itself does not address this topic. Choice B is incorrect because nothing in the underlined sentence indicates how Ac Ko Mok Ki became interested in mapmaking, only that his mapmaking skills are impressive. Choice D is incorrect because though the underlined sentence describes several features of the map, it does not specifically describe how the map was used.

Q7

B

B. To describe an activity that the narrator finds amusing

Choice B is the best answer because it most accurately describes the main purpose of the text. The text describes how the narrator watches people working out at a gym through a window near a bus stop. The narrator says that "there ain't nothing funnier" than watching people try to work out on the stair climber machine. Thus, the main purpose of the text is to describe an activity that the narrator finds amusing.

Choice A is incorrect because the text isn't about the narrator beginning middle school. The text describes how the narrator finds people working out at a gym amusing and makes no mention of school life. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't mention any problems that the narrator currently has or has overcome. It just describes how the narrator finds watching people work out amusing. Choice D is incorrect because the narrator invents the made-up movie mentioned in the text. The text doesn't indicate that the narrator has seen a movie in a theater. The focus of the text is on the narrator watching people at the gym, not watching a movie.

Q8

B

B. It adds to the idea that Bitter's footsteps reveal something to Jam.

Choice B is the best answer because it most accurately describes how the underlined sentence functions in the text as a whole. The text establishes that Jam hears Bitter's studio door open early in the morning, when it is still dark. Jam then listens to her mother's footsteps, which seem to create a song that runs through the floorboards. The text indicates that the sound of Bitter's footsteps convey to Jam that Bitter is done painting. The underlined sentence then builds on this idea, stating explicitly that Bitter's feet sing the news of her completion of a painting. Thus, the sentence stating that "Bitter's feet were singing the news" further emphasizes that Bitter's footsteps themselves reveal information to Jam.

Choice A is incorrect because the text provides no evidence that Jam prefers music to art. While the underlined sentence uses musical imagery to describe the vibrations Jam feels, this is figurative language that is describing the footsteps' vibrations; it isn't an indication of Jam's personal interests. Choice C is incorrect because the text doesn't suggest that Bitter herself sings while working on paintings. The references to singing in the text are figurative descriptions of how Bitter's footsteps sound or feel to Jam, not literal statements about Bitter singing. Choice D is incorrect because the underlined sentence only describes Jam's perception of her mother's footsteps. It doesn't provide any details about Aloe or his reaction to the painting; in fact, the text doesn't mention Aloe seeing the painting at all.

Q9

B

B. It explains the meaning of a word.

Choice B is the best answer because it most accurately describes how the underlined portion functions in the text as a whole. The underlined portion is a parenthetical phrase directly following the word “microfilm,” and it describes film containing small (“scaled-down”) images; the placement and focus of the portion indicate that it is serving to define the term “microfilm.”

Choice A is incorrect. Although the text is about accessing the writings of a famous historical figure (Douglass), the underlined portion doesn’t give information about Douglass or any other person. Instead, it explains what microfilms are. Choice C is incorrect because the text never describes any kind of debate or disagreement; it simply describes a change in how researchers can access historical documents, with the underlined portion defining an important term. Choice D is incorrect because the text never makes any mention of a particular finding, unexpected or otherwise; it simply describes a change in how researchers do some of their work, with the underlined portion defining an important term.

Q10

C

C. It offers a detail about how female cuckoos carry out the behavior discussed in the text.

Choice C is the best answer because it best describes how the underlined sentence functions in the text as a whole. The first two sentences establish that birds of some species don't raise their own young; instead, they lay their eggs in the nests of birds of other species. The underlined sentence then states that female cuckoo birds engage in this behavior, having been observed specifically laying their eggs in other nests while the other birds are out finding food. According to the text, the cuckoo chicks are then raised by the other birds. Thus, the underlined sentence provides a particular detail about how female cuckoos carry out the behavior of laying eggs for other birds to raise.

Choice A is incorrect. Rather than mentioning a physical feature of female cuckoos, the underlined sentence introduces a specific behavior of female cuckoos: laying eggs in the nests of birds of other species when the other birds are away. The only reference to physical features is the last sentence's general mention of cuckoo chicks looking different from chicks of other species. Choice B is incorrect because the underlined sentence refers to the nests of birds other than cuckoos and doesn't describe how any nests look, cuckoo or otherwise. Instead, the sentence addresses how female cuckoos use other birds' nests. Choice D is incorrect because the underlined sentence describes only female cuckoo behavior (laying eggs in the nests of birds of other species when the other birds are away); it's the last sentence of the text that addresses the other birds' reaction, indicating that those birds usually raise the cuckoo chicks once they've hatched.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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